

EARLY REPEATING RIFLES

The development of the unitary cartridge in the mid-19th century paved the way for the “repeater” rifle. This new weapon fed ammunition from a magazine to the breech as part of a single action that emptied the used cartridge case from the chamber, cocked the action, and readied the gun to fire. The first repeaters were mostly American, and used an under-lever design. Europeans, however, were familiar with the bolt action from single-shot Mauser and von Dreyse rifles of the 1870s, and came to prefer it in repeating guns. They considered the bolt action not only easier to use in a prone position, but also safer – because when the bolt was turned, the action was locked by lugs connecting with other parts in the receiver.

▼ SPENCER RIFLE

Date	1863
Origin	US
Weight	4.55kg (10lb)
Barrel	72cm (28¼in)
Calibre	.52in

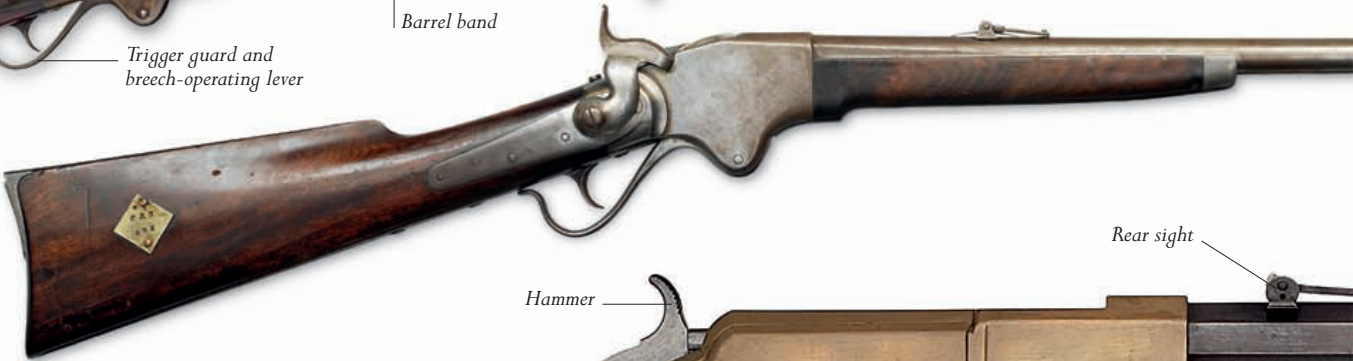
The Spencer, which had a tubular seven-round magazine in the butt stock, was the world’s first practical military repeater. It was adopted by the Union Army in the American Civil War.



► SPENCER CARBINE MODEL 1865

Date	1865
Origin	US
Weight	3.7kg (8lb)
Barrel	51cm (20in)
Calibre	.50in

For this model, Christopher Spencer amended the design of his original repeater rifle and carbine to eliminate minor faults. The 1865 carbine had six-groove rifling. It was also made under contract by the Burnside Rifle Company.



▲ HENRY MODEL 1860

Date	1860
Origin	US
Weight	4kg (8¾lb)
Barrel	51cm (20in)
Calibre	.44in Rim-fire

In Tyler Henry’s repeating rifle, an under-lever ejected a spent round, chambered a new one, and left the action cocked. A two-piece bolt joined by a toggle-joint locked the action.

▲ COLT REVOLVING RIFLE MODEL 1855

Date	1855
Origin	US
Weight	3.45kg (7½lb)
Barrel	68.2cm (26¾in)
Calibre	.56in

The 1855 was the third model of the Colt Manufacturing Company’s 1838 revolving rifle. It made a considerable impact, even though the loading procedure of the five-chambered cylinder was cumbersome.



▼ WINCHESTER CARBINE MODEL 1866

Date	1866
Origin	US
Weight	4.2kg (9¼lb)
Barrel	58.5cm (23in)
Calibre	.44 Rim-fire

A modified Henry Model 1860, the 1866 allowed the reloading – even part-full – of a magazine via a port on the receiver. This doubled the rate of fire to 30 rounds per minute.

